The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Vasudhārā

Āryavasudhārānāmadhāraṇī · Toh 1007 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ནོར་གྱི་རྒྱུན་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Vasudhārā, known in Sanskrit as Āryavasudhārānāmadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Nor gyi Gyün zhejawé Zung, is a short scripture centered on a dhāraṇī, a sacred incantation associated with Vasudhārā, the goddess whose name means "stream of wealth." The text opens at Kauśāmbī, where the Buddha is staying in the Kaṇṭaka forest with a great assembly of monks and bodhisattvas, and a faithful householder named Sucandra, who supports a large family, comes to him for help. In response, the Buddha teaches the Vasudhārā dhāraṇī as a means of bringing prosperity, abundance, and relief from poverty, while placing these material blessings within a framework of faith and the Buddhist path. The work is Toh 1007 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts, a class of scriptures devoted to protective and beneficial incantations.

In the language of India: āryavasudhārānāmadhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Vasudhārā.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Kauśāmbī, in the great and excellent forest called Kaṇṭaka, together with a great Saṅgha of about five hundred monks and a great many bodhisattva great beings who possessed all the qualities of a buddha.

At that time, in the great city of Kauśāmbī, there lived a householder called Sucandra, whose senses were calm and whose mind was calm. He had many sons and daughters and a large household, and he had faith, great faith. He went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him many hundreds of thousands of times, and sat down to one side.

Seated to one side, the householder Sucandra said this to the Blessed One: "If the Blessed One will give me the opportunity to ask, and will answer my question, I would ask the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, about a certain matter."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said to the householder Sucandra: "Householder, ask whatever you wish. By answering whatever question you

ask, I shall gladden your mind."

When he had said this, the householder Sucandra said to the Blessed One, "Excellent!" and, listening to the Blessed One, he said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, how does a son or daughter of good family who has fallen into poverty become free from poverty? And when struck by illness, how do they become free from illness?"

Then the Blessed One, although he knew, said this to the householder Sucandra: "Householder, why do you ask on behalf of the poor?"

When he had said this, the householder Sucandra said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I am very poor, I have many to support, many sons and daughters, and a large household. Therefore, may the Blessed One please explain well that Dharma discourse by which poor beings become free from poverty; by which those struck by illness become free from illness; by which they come to possess much wealth and grain, many treasuries and storehouses; by which they become lovely, pleasing, and delightful to see; by which they become powerful; by which, acting as donors, they are in want of nothing, and become prosperous in treasure, gold, wealth, treasuries of grain and storehouses, in jewels, pearls, diamonds, beryl, conch, crystal, coral, refined gold, and silver, as much as they wish; and by which the members of the family and the household become secure."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said this to the householder Sucandra: "Householder, countless eons ago in the past, at that time and on that occasion, there appeared in the world the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, guide of beings to be tamed, the unsurpassed one, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One called Vajradharasāgaranirghoṣa. Son of good family, from that tathāgata I heard this dhāraṇī called Vasudhārā, took it up and held it, recited it, mastered it, rejoiced in it, and also taught it extensively and correctly to others. Son of good family, I shall explain it to you as well.

"Son of good family, through the power of this dhāraṇī-mantra, humans do not harass. Nonhumans do not harass. Yakṣas do not harass. Rākṣasas do not harass. Hungry ghosts do not harass. Piśācas do not harass. Bhūtas do not harass. Kumbhāṇḍas do not harass. Apasmāras do not harass. Ostārakas do not harass. Kaṭapūtanas do not harass. Asuras do not harass. Those who eat filth as food, those who drink urine as food, those who drink blood as food,

those who eat flesh as food, those who drink pus as food, those who eat fat as food, those who eat marrow as food, those who eat mucus as food, those who eat what flows from the body's openings as food, up to those who feed on the breath drawn in and breathed out, will not harm.

"Son of good family, the son or daughter of good family in whose house this Vasudhārā dhāraṇī is kept, or who keeps it in the heart, or holds it in the hand, or has it in a book, or has heard it, or has mastered it, or has recited it, or has held it, or has rejoiced in it, or has taught it extensively to others, that son or daughter of good family will have, for a long time, benefit, help, virtue, success, happiness, and good harvests.

"Whoever makes offerings to the tathāgatas and recites this Vasudhārā dhāraṇī two, three, or four times at midnight, the deity is pleased with that person. Delighting in the teaching of the Tathāgata, delighted because the Dharma has been made known, delighted because the Saṅgha has been made known, delighted with the one who proclaims the Dharma, and with a superior intention, the deity comes in person and sends down a rain of grain.

namo vajradharasāgarnirghoṣāya tathāgatāya tadyathā oṃ surūve bhadre bhadrāvati adgale maṅgale maṅgalavati ale acale acalavale udghatani udbhedani vasyavati dānapati dhanyapati śrīmati prabhavati amale vimale nirmale ruru surūpe surūpamale vimale cale arcanaste ananaste vinanaste viśvakeśi viśvaniśi aṅkure maṅkure pravaṅkure vīrame vidhame ririme didime dudume khakhame tatare tara tara tāra tāra vajre vajre vajre vame ṭake ṭake ṭhake ṭhake ukke vukke ṭhake ṭharake avartani varaśana ṣadani vajradhārasāgaranirghoṣān tathāgatamanusmara smara smara sarvatathāgata satyamanusmara dharmasatyamanusmara saṅghasatyamanusmara daṭa daṭa pūra pūra pūraya vūraya vūraṇi bhara bharaṇi amale sumaṅgale śāntamati śubhamati maṅgalabhani mahāmati bhadravati prabhavati sucandramati āgccha āgccha samayamanusmara svāhā āparṇimanusmara svāhā prabhavamanusmara svāhā dīdīmanusmara svāhā tejomanusmara svāhā vijayamanusmara svāhā hṛdayamanusmara svāhā sarvasatvavinayamanusmara svāhā oṃ vasudhāre svāhā oṃ vasuśriye svāhā oṃ śrīvasu svāhā oṃ vasu svāhā

"Son of good family, this is the dhāraṇī called Vasudhārā. Through the power of this dhāraṇī-mantra, famine, disease, and death will not arise.

"Son of good family, whoever makes offerings to the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas, and recites these secret mantra words of the

Vasudhārā dhāraṇī for a single night will then gain accomplishment.

"For the sake of increase, whether in one's own house, in another's house, in a clean place, in a storehouse, or in any place at all, if one makes a square maṇḍala with sandalwood for the Tathāgata Avalokiteśvara, for the buddhas and all the bodhisattvas, and for the deities of the secret mantra, and recites it for a single night, then the house of that son of good family will be filled with a stream of wealth, grain, gold and silver, and every necessity, merely through the name of the great one. All fear and all harm will also vanish.

"Therefore, son of good family, apply yourself with diligence: hold this Vasudhārā dhāraṇī! Chant it! Read it! Teach it! Teach it extensively and correctly to others as well! That will be for your long-lasting welfare, benefit, and happiness."

"Excellent, Blessed One!" he replied. Having heard this Vasudhārā dhāraṇī from the Blessed One, the householder Sucandra was satisfied, joyful, delighted, and pleased; he rejoiced greatly, and joy and gladness arose in him. He bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, I have received what is called Vasudhārā. I have taken it in as a dhāraṇī and hold it. I have read it. I have mastered it. I have rejoiced in it, and I shall teach it extensively and correctly to others as well."

In that very instant the storehouses of the householder Sucandra became completely full. Then the householder Sucandra circumambulated the Blessed One many hundreds of thousands of times, bowed at the Blessed One's feet, and departed from the Blessed One's presence.

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda, "Ānanda, go and look at the house of the householder Sucandra, its abundance, completely filled with wealth and grain, its great treasuries, and its completely full storehouses."

Then the venerable Ānanda, having heeded the Blessed One, went to the great city of Kauśāmbī, to the house of the householder Sucandra. Arriving there, he went inside, and he saw an abundance completely filled with wealth and grain, an abundance of jewels, great treasuries of every necessity, and storehouses that were completely full as well. Having seen this, he was satisfied, joyful, delighted, and pleased; he rejoiced greatly, joy and gladness arose in him, and he went to where the Blessed One was.

Then the venerable Ānanda, filled with wonder and with joy and gladness arisen in him, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what is the cause, and

what is the condition, by which the householder Sucandra has great wealth, and his great treasuries and storehouses abound in wealth and grain?"

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, it is because that son of good family, the householder Sucandra, who has faith, supreme faith, and a virtuous intention, held this Vasudhārā dhāraṇī and recited it thoroughly, received it, read it, mastered it, rejoiced in it, and taught it extensively and correctly to others as well.

"Therefore, Ānanda, you too should take up this Vasudhārā dhāraṇī! Chant it! Read it! Teach it! Hold it! Master it! Teach it extensively and correctly to others as well! That will be for the benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, and for the welfare, benefit, and happiness of the great multitude, of gods and humans.

"Ānanda, in this world with its gods, its māras, and its Brahmās, with its ascetics and brahmins, its gods, humans, and asuras, I see no one who could make this vidyā-mantra turn out otherwise. Whether it is recited twice or recited three times, there is no possibility of its failing. Ānanda, these secret mantra words of the dhāraṇī are indestructible."

Ānanda, these words will not even reach the ears of sentient beings whose roots of virtue are exhausted. What need, then, to speak of their writing them out in books or keeping them in mind? And why is that? Because this is the word of all the tathāgatas. For the sake of all sentient beings who are poor, who are tormented by various illnesses, who are afraid, and who are harmed by the hostility of other beings, all the tathāgatas have spoken this dhāraṇī-mantra. They have explained it, rejoiced in it, revealed it, praised it, elucidated it, and made it clear. They have brought it forth, blessed it, sealed it with the seal of the Dharma, extolled it, eulogized it, made it understood, and proclaimed it.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, joined his palms, and at that moment uttered this inspired utterance, offering these verses:

The Buddha, the Blessed One, is inconceivable;
the Buddha's Dharma too is inconceivable.
For those who have faith in the inconceivable,
the ripening too is inconceivable.
Peaceful one, who knows whatever there is, all-knowing one,
King of Dharma, free of aging and death,
who has gone to the far shore of wisdom,

Buddha, hero, to you I bow.

Then the venerable Ānanda was satisfied, delighted, pleased, and glad. Utterly overjoyed, with joy and happiness arising in him, he said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what is the name of this Dharma discourse? How should it be remembered?"

The Blessed One said, "Ānanda, remember it as The Questions of the Householder Sucandra. Remember it also as The Treasury of All Wealth, Grain, and Jewels. Remember it also as The Vasudhārā Dhāraṇī, Praised by All the Tathāgatas."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the venerable Ānanda, those monks, those bodhisattvas, that whole assembly, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the dhāraṇī called the Noble Vasudhārā.

Translator's Notes

• The phrase rendered "silver, as much as they wish" reads dbul bsam 'tshal in the Tibetan. Here dbul ("poor") makes no sense in a list of valuables, so it is taken as a slip for dngul ("silver"). The forest name □□□□□□□□ ("Thorny") is rendered by its Sanskrit form Kaṇṭaka. □□□□□□□ is given as ostāraka and □□□□□□□□□□□ as kaṭapūtana, following the standard equivalences for these classes of spirits. The name of the dhāraṇī, □□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Stream of Wealth"), is given in its Sanskrit form Vasudhārā throughout.
• The phrase rendered "merely through the name of the great one" (mi chen po'i mtshan tsam gyis) is obscure. It may refer to the mere name of the great being invoked in the rite. It may also be read otherwise; for example, mtshan can mean "night," which would give a sense like "in just a single night," or the text may be corrupt.
• Vasudhārā literally means "stream of wealth." Here the title is given in its Sanskrit form to match the rest of the text.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.